

Module 18: Power BI Administration & Governance

Overview

As Power BI adoption grows across an organization, managing reports, users, workspaces, security, and compliance becomes increasingly important.

Without governance, organizations can face problems such as:

- Duplicate reports
- Conflicting KPIs
- Security risks
- Uncontrolled workspace creation
- Poor data quality
- Compliance violations

Power BI Administration and Governance provide the framework for managing Power BI at an enterprise scale.

This module covers Power BI administration, tenant settings, governance frameworks, workspace management, auditing, monitoring, compliance, and enterprise BI best practices.

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Understand Power BI administration
 - Manage tenant settings
 - Understand capacity management
 - Implement governance frameworks
 - Manage workspaces effectively
 - Monitor Power BI usage
 - Use audit logs
 - Apply compliance standards
 - Build enterprise governance strategies
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Table of Contents

1. Introduction to Administration & Governance
2. Why Governance Matters
3. Power BI Administrative Roles
4. Power BI Tenant
5. Tenant Settings
6. Capacity Management
7. Workspace Governance

8. Data Governance
 9. Report Governance
 10. Semantic Model Governance
 11. Audit Logs
 12. Usage Monitoring
 13. Compliance & Regulatory Requirements
 14. Data Lineage
 15. Deployment Strategies
 16. Center of Excellence (CoE)
 17. Best Practices
 18. Common Mistakes
 19. Key Terminologies
 20. Practice Exercises
 21. Mini Project
 22. Module Summary
-

1 Introduction to Administration & Governance

What is Power BI Administration?

Administration involves managing:

- Users
 - Workspaces
 - Security
 - Capacity
 - Tenant Settings
-

What is Governance?

Governance is the framework that ensures Power BI is used consistently, securely, and effectively across an organization.

Goal

Create a trusted, scalable, and secure analytics environment.

2 Why Governance Matters

Without governance:

Multiple Versions of Reports

Different teams create conflicting reports.

KPI Inconsistency

Revenue calculations differ between departments.

Security Risks

Sensitive data becomes accessible.

Compliance Issues

Regulatory requirements may be violated.

Governance Benefits

- Consistency
 - Security
 - Scalability
 - Compliance
 - Trust
-

Power BI Administrative Roles

Power BI includes several administrative roles.

Power BI Administrator

Responsible for:

- Tenant settings
 - User management
 - Governance policies
-

Global Administrator

Microsoft 365-wide administration.

Capacity Administrator

Manages Premium capacities.

Workspace Administrator

Manages workspace content.

Role Hierarchy

```
Global Admin
  ↓
Power BI Admin
  ↓
Capacity Admin
  ↓
Workspace Admin
```

Power BI Tenant

What is a Tenant?

A tenant is an organization's Power BI environment.

Example

A company may have:

```
companyname.onmicrosoft.com
```

Tenant Contains

- Users
 - Workspaces
 - Reports
 - Dashboards
 - Security Settings
-

Importance

All governance policies apply at the tenant level.

Tenant Settings

What are Tenant Settings?

Tenant settings control organization-wide Power BI behavior.

Examples

Export Data

Allow or restrict exports.

Publish to Web

Control public sharing.

Create Workspaces

Restrict workspace creation.

AI Features

Enable or disable AI functionality.

Access

```
Power BI Admin Portal
  ↓
Tenant Settings
```

Capacity Management

What is Capacity?

Capacity represents computing resources used by Power BI.

Types

Shared Capacity

Standard cloud resources.

Premium Capacity

Dedicated enterprise resources.

Benefits of Premium

Larger Models

Better Performance

Enterprise Features

Responsibilities

Capacity administrators monitor:

- Memory
 - CPU
 - Refresh workloads
-

Workspace Governance

Why Workspace Governance Matters

Poor workspace management causes:

- Duplicate content
 - Security confusion
 - Maintenance difficulties
-

Best Practices

Create Standard Naming Conventions

Example:

```
Sales_Analytics  
Finance_Analytics  
HR_Analytics
```

Assign Owners

Every workspace should have responsible owners.

Limit Workspace Creation

Prevent unnecessary workspaces.

Archive Inactive Workspaces

Reduce clutter.



Data Governance

What is Data Governance?

Data Governance ensures data quality, consistency, and reliability.

Objectives

Accuracy

Data must be correct.

Consistency

Same definitions across reports.

Security

Protect sensitive information.

Ownership

Clearly defined responsibility.

Example

Revenue should have one agreed definition organization-wide.



Report Governance

Purpose

Ensure reports meet organizational standards.

Governance Areas

Naming Standards

Design Standards

Documentation

Testing

Approval Process

Benefits

Improved consistency and usability.

10 Semantic Model Governance

Why Important?

Semantic models are often reused by multiple reports.

Governance Goals

Single Source of Truth

One approved dataset.

Measure Standardization

Shared calculations.

Documentation

Clear definitions.

Example

Total Revenue

should be defined once and reused.

1 1 Audit Logs

What are Audit Logs?

Audit logs record Power BI activities.

Examples

Report Access

Who viewed reports?

Sharing Activity

Who shared content?

Export Activity

Who exported data?

Deletion Activity

Who removed content?

Benefits

- Security Monitoring
 - Compliance Tracking
 - Investigation Support
-

1 2 Usage Monitoring

Why Monitor Usage?

Understand adoption and value.

Metrics

Active Users

Report Views

Dashboard Views

Workspace Activity

Benefits

Identify Popular Reports

Remove Unused Content

Improve Adoption

Compliance & Regulatory Requirements

Many organizations operate under regulations.

Common Frameworks

GDPR

European privacy regulation.

HIPAA

Healthcare compliance.

SOX

Financial reporting compliance.

ISO Standards

Information security frameworks.

Governance Role

Ensure Power BI aligns with compliance requirements.

Data Lineage

What is Data Lineage?

Data lineage tracks the flow of data.

Example

```
graph TD; A[SQL Database] --> B[Power Query]; B --> C[Semantic Model]; C --> D[Report]; D --> E[Dashboard];
```

Benefits

Impact Analysis

Understand downstream effects.

Troubleshooting

Identify data issues.

Governance

Improve transparency.

1 **5** Deployment Strategies

Why Deployment Matters

Changes should be controlled.

Recommended Process

```
graph TD; A[Development] --> B[Testing]; B --> C[Production];
```

Benefits

Reduced Risk

Better Quality

Easier Rollback

Tools

Deployment Pipelines.

Center of Excellence (CoE)

What is a CoE?

A Center of Excellence is a team responsible for promoting Power BI best practices.

Responsibilities

Governance

Training

Standards

Support

Innovation

Benefits

Improved Power BI maturity across the organization.

Best Practices

Define Governance Policies Early

Standardize Naming Conventions

-
- Control Workspace Creation
-
- Monitor Usage Regularly
-
- Use Audit Logs
-
- Document Semantic Models
-
- Establish Data Ownership
-
- Create Approval Processes
-

18 Common Mistakes

- No Governance Framework
-
- Unlimited Workspace Creation
-
- Duplicate Semantic Models
-
- No Data Ownership
-
- Ignoring Audit Logs
-
- Lack of Documentation
-
- Poor Security Controls
-

Key Terminologies

Term	Definition
Governance	Framework for managing Power BI usage
Tenant	Organization's Power BI environment

Term	Definition
Capacity	Computing resources for Power BI
Workspace	Collaborative environment
Audit Log	Activity tracking record
Data Lineage	Data flow tracking
Compliance	Regulatory adherence
Semantic Model	Centralized business dataset
CoE	Center of Excellence
Administration	Management of Power BI resources



Practice Exercises

Exercise 1

Identify governance risks in an organization with:

- No workspace standards
 - Duplicate reports
 - No security policies
-

Exercise 2

Design a workspace naming convention.

Exercise 3

Create a governance checklist for Power BI projects.

Exercise 4

Map data lineage for a sales reporting solution.

Exercise 5

Define responsibilities for a Power BI Center of Excellence.



Mini Project

Enterprise Governance Framework

Scenario

A company has:

- 500 Power BI users
 - 50 workspaces
 - Multiple departments
 - No governance standards
-

Tasks

Governance Framework

Create standards for:

- Workspaces
 - Reports
 - Semantic Models
 - Security
-

Monitoring Plan

Track:

- Usage
 - Sharing
 - Exports
-

Compliance Strategy

Address:

- Data Privacy
 - Security
 - Access Control
-

Deliverables

1. Governance Policy Document
 2. Workspace Standards
 3. Security Framework
 4. Monitoring Dashboard Plan
-



Module Summary

In this module, you learned:

- ✓ Power BI Administration
- ✓ Tenant Management
- ✓ Tenant Settings
- ✓ Capacity Management
- ✓ Workspace Governance
- ✓ Data Governance
- ✓ Report Governance
- ✓ Semantic Model Governance
- ✓ Audit Logs
- ✓ Usage Monitoring
- ✓ Compliance & Regulations
- ✓ Data Lineage
- ✓ Deployment Strategies
- ✓ Center of Excellence (CoE)

Governance is essential for scaling Power BI successfully. A strong governance framework ensures security, consistency, compliance, and trust while supporting long-term analytics growth.



Next Module

Module 19: Power BI Deployment Pipelines & DevOps

Topics Covered:

- Power BI Development Lifecycle
- Deployment Pipelines
- CI/CD Concepts
- Version Control
- Git Integration
- Environment Management
- Automated Deployments
- Testing Strategies
- Release Management
- Enterprise DevOps Practices